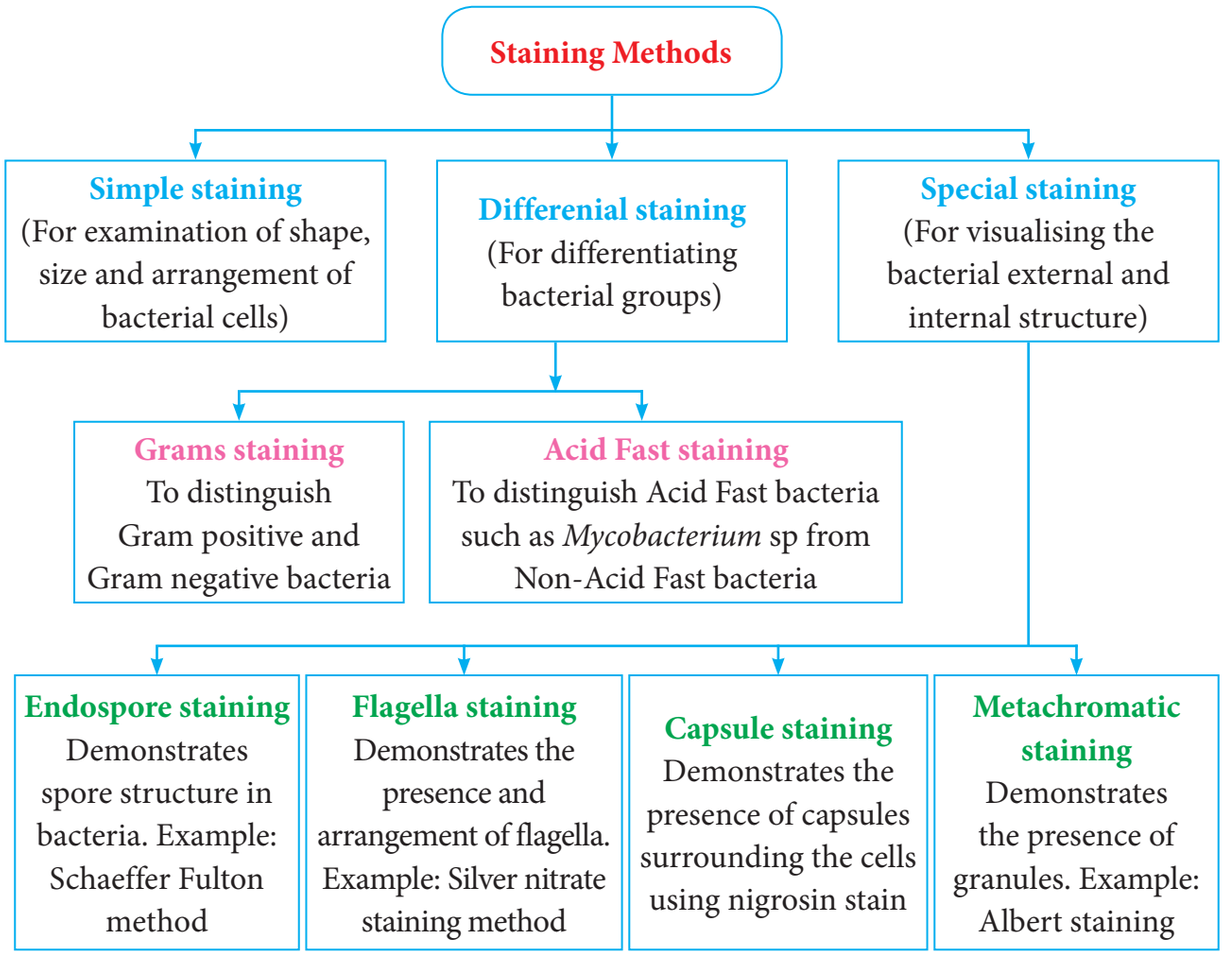
i) Simple staining method

ii) Differential staining method

iii) Special staining method.

Different types of bacterial staining methods are summarized in Flowchart 3.1



Flowchart 3.1: Types of Bacterial Staining methods

3.6 Simple Staining Method

In Simple Staining method only one stain is used. Stain is applied to the smear in one application. The fixed smear on the glass slide is flooded with a staining solution for about one minute. The solution is then washed off with water and the slide is blot dried. The stained slide is examined under a microscope (Figure 3.6). The cells stain uniformly. The simple stains used by the microbiologists for routine purposes are dilute solutions of Methylene blue, Crystal violet, Safranin and Carbol fuchsin.

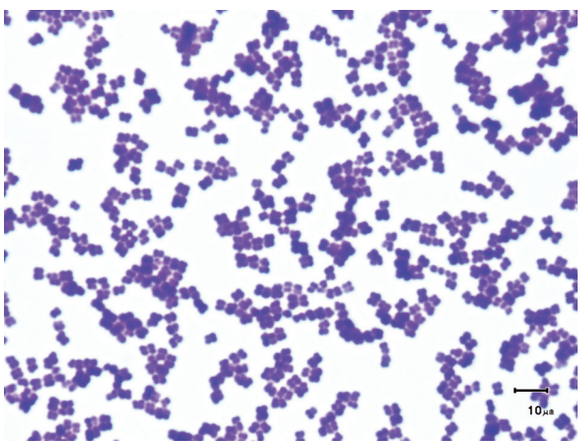


Figure 3.6: Simple stain – *Micrococcus sp.* stained with Methylene blue

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